

Stored Procedure vs Function: A procedure can have IN, OUT, or INOUT parameters and may or may not return a value (using OUT params or SELECT), while a function must return a single value and only uses IN parameters. Procedures are for actions/operations; functions are for computations and can be used inside SQL expressions.

IN vs OUT Parameters: IN parameters are read-only inputs passed to the procedure (default), while OUT parameters are write-only variables that return values from the procedure to the caller. INOUT combines both—passes a value in and returns a modified value out.

How they are invoked: A stored procedure is called using `CALL procedure_name(parameters);` (e.g., `CALL GetEmp(5);`). A stored function is invoked as part of an expression, like `SELECT function_name(parameters);` or inside a query (e.g., `SELECT calculate_bonus(salary) FROM employee;`).